

Homework 2

ASEN 5335 Aerospace Environment

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Problem 1: Spaceballs

Problem 2: Atmospheric Scale Height

To calculate the scale height H of air mixture assuming N_2/O_2 mixture at sea level, we use the equation.

$$H = \frac{kT}{mg}$$

Where we assume a constant $T = 300$ K from the problem, and $k = 1.38 \times 10^{-23}$ J/K, the Boltzmann constant, $g = 9.81$ m/s², the gravitational constant. We then seek the molecular mass of N_2/O_2 mixture. This can be obtained from the table provided in the HW. We find the atomic mass of the air mixture provided with the % by volume

$$amu_{air} = 28.0134 (.781) + 31.9988 (.209) = 28.566 \text{ g/mol}$$

$$m_{air} = amu_{air} * \frac{1 \text{ kg}}{1000 \text{ g} * 6.02 * 10^{23} \text{ g/mol}}$$

$$m_{air} = 4.745 * 10^{-26} \text{ kg}$$

This process of finding molecular weight and converting it can be repeated for atomic Oxygen, helium, and hydrogen.

$$amu_{oxygen} = (31.9988 \text{ g/mol})/2 = 15.9994 \text{ g/mol}$$

$$amu_{helium} = 4.0026 \text{ g/mol}$$

$$amu_{hydrogen} = 2.01594 \text{ g/mol}$$

$$m_{oxygen} = 2.6577 * 10^{-26} \text{ kg}$$

$$m_{helium} = 6.6488 * 10^{-27} \text{ kg}$$

$$m_{hydrogen} = 3.3487 * 10^{-27} \text{ kg}$$

The scale height equation can be used with each respective molecular mass of the species in question.

$$H_{air} = 8.8938 * 10^3 \text{ m}$$

$$H_{oxygen} = 1.588 * 10^4 \text{ m}$$

$$H_{helium} = 6.347 * 10^4 \text{ m}$$

$$H_{hydrogen} = 1.2602 * 10^5 \text{ m}$$

Problem 3: Atmosphere Variation

Problem 4: Oxygen Impact

Problem 5: Orbit Decay

Problem 6: Atmosphere Uncertainty and Neutral Winds

Problem 7: Air Breathing Thruster

Problem 8: Missions